Ishkhan Khchoian

Product Manager — 0-to-1, discovery & delivery

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Armenian (native) · Russian (native) · English (C1)

PROFILE

I am currently COO of **SayWhen.am**, an early-stage startup building AI voice agents that handle inbound and outbound business calls — natural conversation instead of phone menus, multilingual, integrated with a client's CRM and calendar, with transcripts and call analytics. The product works and a demo is available; we are taking it to market and plan to tailor each deployment to the specific client, so my week is discovery with prospects, scoping what a given customer would actually need, and turning that into what gets built next.

Before this I spent six years on the operating side — running up to 12 complex projects in parallel, coordinating 8 specialists, and rewriting the processes two organizations still work from. That combination — operating discipline plus hands-on product work with real customers — is what I bring to a product team.

One interview is enough — give me 30 minutes and a real problem from your team, and you'll see how I work.

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO IN PRODUCT

- **Customer discovery, for real.** Our whole go-to-market is discovery-led: every prospective client gets interviewed about their call flows before anything is configured. I have also run several hundred structured client-intake interviews in a previous career — the skill of asking past the stated request is the one I have practiced longest.
- **Scoping a raw product into a shippable one.** Deciding what to build for the client in front of you, what to generalize, and what to refuse is the weekly 0-to-1 judgment call. I make it with engineers, not at them.
- **Requirements engineers can act on.** My rewritten workflows, templates and checklists at M&M became the team default. Writing something precise enough that other people execute it without me is the part of the job I enjoy most.
- **Where conversational products break.** Retrieval that returns the plausible answer instead of the right one, handover to a human, and the gap between what callers actually say and what the happy path assumed. I have hit all three while building and testing the product.
- **Evidence over opinion.** Six years of legal analysis: read a dense corpus, find the fact that decides the outcome, defend it in writing against a hostile reader. That is the same muscle as defending a prioritization call with data.
- **Domain range.** Law, construction, events and retail — I can interview a lawyer, a site manager or a venue producer in their own vocabulary. For a B2B product, the discovery bottleneck is usually the interviewer, not the user.
- **Three languages.** Armenian and Russian native, English C1 — the same three our product ships in.

PRODUCT & INDEPENDENT WORK

Chief Operating Officer — SayWhen.am (AI voice agents for business) Feb 2026 – present

- Own operations and the client-facing half of the product: discovery with prospects, scoping deployments, and feeding what prospects ask for back into the roadmap.
- The product handles inbound and outbound calls in **Armenian, Russian and English**, with CRM and knowledge-base integration, calendar booking, live transcripts and call analytics.
- Early stage and pre-scale: the build is working and will be tailored per client, so prioritizing what to generalize is a live weekly decision. Demo available on request.

Independent consultant — legal, research and commercial projects Feb 2026 – present

- Business research for a water production line.
- Corporate structure design for a crypto trader; advised a St. Petersburg entrepreneur on setting up a crypto-exchange operation in Armenia.
- IP assignment for popular musicians' works; CPA/affiliate manager (under NDA); sale of family real estate.
- **Karas Systems** (B2B go-to-market consultancy): designed a 12-week U.S. client-acquisition pilot — triggers chosen by a scoring model, prospect tiers, outreach sequence, funnel model in three scenarios, budget, payback and decision gates.

OPERATING EXPERIENCE

Senior Case Manager — M&M Document Preparation Jun 2025 – Feb 2026

- Up to **12 complex client projects in parallel**, end to end, against immovable deadlines; coordinated **8 specialists** against written acceptance criteria.
- Rewrote the workflows, templates and checklists; they became the team standard.

Event / Project Manager — Hosq Corp. Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

- Live events for **100–3,000** people — concerts, festivals, Miro's corporate conference and a touring TV show — several in parallel, on dates that could not move.

Project Manager — Qanon Construction Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Client communication, scope agreement, timelines and internal follow-through.

Senior Paralegal — Shamayev Business Law Corp. · Paralegal — Bloomrich Law Firm Feb 2023 – Aug 2024

- Built and taught the **Paralegal Academy**, an internal training program used by **50+ people**; carried key accounts with full autonomy.

Judge's Associate — Arbitration Court Nov 2021 – Dec 2022

- **200+ parallel cases, 30+ hearings a week**, covering three roles at once.

Assistant Lawyer — Bar Association Dec 2019 – Aug 2021

- Civil-contract analysis and claims; legal support to a trade and construction organization.

Administrator / Project Manager — LLC "SIS" (construction & retail) Jun 2015 – Sep 2019

- **15+ projects**, up to three sites at once, teams of 2–20; tenders, procurement and contractors.

SKILLS

- **Product:** customer discovery and interviews · requirements, user stories and acceptance criteria · scoping and prioritization · roadmap input · competitor and market research · metric definition · conversational-AI and RAG fundamentals
- **Delivery:** scope and timelines · Agile/Scrum · backlog grooming · risk tracking · SOPs, checklists and runbooks · cross-functional coordination · leading teams up to 20
- **Tools:** Jira · Confluence · Notion · Trello · Monday · Google Analytics · amoCRM · Bitrix24 · Google Workspace · basic C

EDUCATION & TRAINING

- **Project management, U.S. perspective** — "Project Management with a U.S. Perspective: Skills for Global Success" — Yerevan American Corner, a joint program of the U.S. Embassy Yerevan and the City Central Isahakyan Library; Jul 21 – Aug 21, 2026, in person, Certificate of Achievement.
- **Project Management** — PM Club, 2023 (52 hours).
- **Piscine intensive (C programming)** — 42 Yerevan, Nov–Dec 2025; passed selection and completed it alongside a full-time job.
- **Bachelor of Law, with honors** — North-Eastern State University, 2021.
- **Civil Law, Faculty of Law** — St. Petersburg State University, 2016.